

RAMAN ROY —
VENTURE CAPITALIST

LEARNING IS MORE CRUCIAL THAN EARNING IN FIRST JOB

After completing my chartered accountancy, I got four job offers. Unsure about which one to take up, I approached my mentor, Vinod Mehta, a chartered accountant, for advice. Surprisingly, he picked AF Ferguson, the company that offered the lowest pay. He explained that my learning should not stop with my degree and that I ought to choose a company that offered the maximum scope for enhancing my knowledge. My experience in AF Ferguson turned out to be exactly as Mehta had predicted. Another valuable piece of advice was from my boss at American Express, Anuroop (Tony) Singh. He wanted me to take on the operations division but I was wedded to my accounting skills. Singh told me accounting was my chief ability but I should expand my skill sets. I followed his advice and found the add-ons useful especially when setting up BPO units for various companies and also my own. —As told to Rajshree Kukreti



BALANCE AMBITION AND REALISM

Someone once told me: "Reach for the stars but always keep one foot on the ground." It's a piece of advice that's more philosophical than merely practical in nature and hence can be applied to every sphere of life. I have tried to incorporate this philosophy in everything I do and these words have never failed me. It is a fact that ambition can be overwhelming. While challenging yourself to reach the next peak, it can sometimes prove difficult to hold on to values such as integrity. It also might get difficult to stay in touch with reality. This advice to keep one foot on the ground while reaching high has always kept me grounded, even when I was flying high. Success, whether it is in business or in investing, is really no reason to lose sight of reality. —As told to Shankkar Aiyar

L.N. MITTAL —
STEEL TYCOON

BANDEEP SINGH



DON'T NEGLECT YOUR KEY SKILLS

Money was never a big thing for me until I lost my father in 2004. My closest friend Apurva Mehta told me to play the stock market like my father used to. Shah Rukh Khan told me that I should not be embarrassed about being paid for certain endorsements. Then Aditya Chopra said I should never do anything to compromise the master brand since everything else is dependent on my making films. Finally, there's my mother, who constantly advises me to invest in property, to which I tell her I will once I have the money! —As told to Kaveree Bamzai

WITHOUT RISK THERE IS NO REWARD

There is never a shortage of advice, particularly when it comes to finance. Every other magazine and newspaper tells you how you can beat the markets. But I feel that this is ultimately self-defeating, because if everyone is following it, how can you benefit? Rather than general platitudes, I value advice that is more specific and tells you how to crack a problem. My father has been handling my Indian investments and tells me that stocks are the best investment. I've concluded that stocks are the best way to beat inflation. One thing that emerges from most good financial advice is that you have to take risks to get good returns. —As told to Sharda Ugra

V. ANAND —
WORLD CHESS CHAMP

ISHAN TANKHA

